METRIC

A-A-54923
8 October 1993

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

WAX, BONE

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description as a replacement for Military Specification MIL-W-36795(2), which is cancelled.

This Commercial Item Description covers sterile bone wax suitable for use in orthopedic surgery and suitable for hemostasis in the treatment of bone cavities.

Salient characteristics:

Material. The bone wax shall be a mixture of bees wax and almond oil, with 2 percent (± 0.5 percent) salicylic acid or a mixture of mismo bees wax and isopropyl palmitate. The ratio of ingredients shall be such that the melting point of the bone wax shall not be less than 57.0 degrees centigrade (^{o}C) nor more than 65.0^{o} C. The finished product shall be of such consistency as to be suitable for hemostasis in the treatment of bone cavities.

The bees wax shall be either white or yellow as monographed in the USP or NF. All ingredients which are monographed in USP or NF shall comply with those compendia in all respects. If an ingredient is not monographed in the USP or NF, it shall be of a high quality and a purity suitable for the intended use.

Packet assembly. Each packet shall contain 2 to 3 grams (gm.) of bone wax. Each packet shall consist of an inner and outer container as specified.

Foil inner container. The foil container shall be a combination of plastic and aluminum foil closed by heat sealing, and shall be fabricated in such a manner and of such material as to maintain the sterility of the bone wax. The sealed foil container shall have two free tabs along the top edge capable of being readily peeled back along the edges to expose the bone wax.

AMSC N/A FSC 6515

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Tube type inner container. As an alternate, the sterile bone wax shall be contained in a suitable tin or tin-copper alloy tube dispenser. The weight of the wax and dispenser shall not exceed 6 grams. The dispenser shall be suitable for dispensing bone wax during surgical procedures.

Outer container. The outer container shall be fabricated of a combination of plastic and aluminum foil closed by heat sealing, and shall be fabricated in such a manner and of such material as to maintain the sterility of the inner container. The sealed outer container shall have two free tabs along the top edge, capable of being readily peeled back along the sealed edges to expose the inner container. The outer container shall be so designed as to permit ready dispensing of the sterile inner container by aseptic techniques.

Sterility. The entire contents of the packet assembly shall be sterile when tested as specified.

Salicylic acid content determination. The salicylic acid content shall be determined as specified.

Melting point. The melting point of the wax shall be no less than 57°C nor more than 65.0°C when tested as specified.

Item identification. The inner container shall be legibly marked with the item name, and name or registered trademark of the manufacturer.

Sterility. The bone wax shall be sterile when tested in accordance with the USP or AAMI guidelines. Sterility Assurance Level shall be 0.00001.

Workmanship. The bone wax shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Package (PG). One package containing 12 immediate containers of one type only, as specified, constitutes one unit. Bone wax shall be packaged in either of the following immediate containers:

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Two to 3 grams of bone wax shall be supplied in a heat-sealed peel-open plastic and foil waterproof immediate container capable of maintaining sterility of contents unless package is damaged or opened. As an alternate, 2 to 3 grams of bone wax shall be supplied in a suitable tin or tin-copper alloy tube dispenser suitable for dispensing bone wax during surgical procedures. The immediate container shall be further packaged in a heat-sealed peel-open plastic and foil outer container, which shall permit ready dispensing of the sterile inner container by aseptic techniques.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after the delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Examination. Examination shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified. Unit of product for examination purposes shall be one package of bone wax as specified. Sampling shall be inspection level II with an Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) of 1.0.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sterility test. Each sterility lot shall be sterile when tested for sterility in accordance with the sampling and sterility test methods of the USP for ointments.

Methods for determination of salicylic acid in bone wax. The determination of salicylic acid for compliance with requirements of this specification shall be performed as specified.

Reagents. Reagents to be used in determination of salicylic acid shall be as follows:

(1) Benzene-Methanol Solution: Benzene, U.S.P. Reagent, 3 Volumes, plus Methanol, U.S.P. Reagent, 1 Volume.

(2) Ferric nitrate solution: 1.0 gm. $Fe(NO_3)_3 \cdot 9H_2O$ in 100 cubic centimeters (cc.) of 1.0% HNO_3.

(3) Standard solutions. Accurately weigh exactly 0.500 gm. of salicylic acid and dissolve in water to make 500 cc. Four standard solutions shall be prepared by diluting each of 0.5 cc., 1.0 cc., 1.5 cc., and 2.0 cc. portions of the salicylic acid solution, described above, with distilled water to make 50 cc.

Procedure. Dissolve approximately 50 milligrams (mg.) of bone wax, accurately weighed, in 3 cc. of Benzene-Methanol Solution contained in a 50 cc. volumetric flask, warming gently, if necessary. To the cooled solution add exactly 5.0 cc. of ferric nitrate solution. Then add enough water to make approximately 45 cc. and shake vigorously for 1 minute. Allow the two immiscible liquids to separate, and then add water to bring the aqueous layer to the 50 cc. mark. Draw off the benzene layer by means of a medicine dropper, pipette, or other suitable means. Centrifuge a portion of the aqueous solution to free the solution from suspended benzene droplets. Determine the absorbance of this aqueous solution by use of a suitable spectrophotometer, at wave length 525 millimicrons. Use a solution, prepared with the same quantities of the same reagents in a similar manner as a blank. Prepare a calibration curve of the standard solutions employing the above method and reagents. Determine the concentration of the sample solution from this curve.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Method for determination of melting point. The melting point determination shall be conducted in accordance with procedure for class II or III as specified, under "Melting Range or Temperature", in the current edition of the Pharmacopeia of the United States. Three samples from each lot shall be tested. If the variation among the three determinations is less than 1 degree, their arithmetical average shall be considered as the melting point of the lot represented. If the variation among the three determinations is greater than 1 degree, two additional determinations shall be made and the arithmetical average of the five determinations shall be considered as the melting point of the lot represented.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified. Unit of product for test purposes shall be one package of bone wax. Sampling shall be inspection level S-2 with an AQL of 1.0.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch-pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling, and marking must be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number and its respective Item Identification is covered by this document:

National Stock Number	Item Identification
6515-00-965-2511	Wax, Bone, Sterile, 12 Packets

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army-MD
Navy-MS
Air Force-03

Preparing Activity:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
USPHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6515-5433
Location: c:\word\paul\wax

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS

1. The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8. In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given
2. The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7
3. The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form

NOTE This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification of requirements on current contracts Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements

I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1 DOCUMENT NUMBER A-A-54923	2 DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD) 931008

3 DOCUMENT TITLE
WAX, BONE

4 NATURE OF CHANGE *(Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible Attach extra sheets as needed.)*

5 REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6 SUBMITTER

a NAME (Last, First, Middle Initial)	b ORGANIZATION
c ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	d TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (If applicable)
	7 DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8 PREPARING ACTIVITY

a NAME Defense Personnel Support Center ATTN: DPSC-MSE	b TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial: (215)7372870 (2) AUTOVON: 444-2870
c ADDRESS (Include Zip Code) 2800 South 20th Street Philadelphia, PA 19145	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike, Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22041-3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.